

# Tobias Treppmann

Ten years developing people who were under no obligation to listen

LOCATION Berlin, Germany

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## PROFILE

M.A. in Leadership, and a decade mentoring and coaching alongside every job I have held. The people I developed at CareerFoundry and the Interaction Design Foundation did not report to me and could have stopped listening at any point. As a team lead I built the instruments rather than improvising them: a levelling framework across two disciplines, growth plans, performance reviews, and a 360 I ran as a workshop. I held the Secretary and Facilitator roles under Holacracy at Hypoport and ran governance meetings, so shared leadership is a model I have operated inside a constitution rather than read about. Native German, Berlin.

## A decade, no authority

mentoring people who did not report to me and could have stopped listening

## Geteilte Führung, served

Holacracy Secretary and Facilitator at Hypoport, governance meetings run

## EXPERIENCE

### Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

*Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany*

- Head of Product Design, and product manager and product owner for the redesign.
- Design leadership across B2B SaaS, enterprise analytics and broadcast is the context for this application.

### Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

*ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin*

- Led all product design across the company, and held product management for the main platform alongside it.
- Six countries under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic data-protection law, with Landeskirchen as public-law customers.
- Six countries, one platform.

### Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

*Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany*

- Nine people at the peak, across four disciplines — design, UX writing, product management and data science — for four months, on the senior leadership team. Five as the steady state.
- Developed a levelling framework covering design and UX writing. Two disciplines, which is the part most teams with writers on them never solve.
- It set clear expectations per level, and I used it for growth plans so a junior designer and a junior writer could see what reaching the next one required.
- Ran performance reviews. Hired two and promoted two.
- Building talent was the point of the framework. Growth plans named what reaching the next role required, and I hired the consultant who then filled the Head of Product role permanently.
- Designed a lean 360 as a workshop rather than a survey, so the feedback happened in a room between the people it was about.
- An engineer was being sidelined in meetings. I changed how the meetings ran — pre-meeting prep, written agendas, structured turn-taking.
- That engineer became one of the strongest contributors. The conditions were the problem, not the person.
- Coached a team lead through a working relationship that had broken down with a counterpart in another function.
- Agile delivery in a matrix organization — designers assigned across product teams, with the design function held centrally.
- Two disciplines, one framework.
- Two hires. Two promotions.

### Product and UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

*Hypoport hub SE (shared service center of the listed Hypoport SE, run under Holacracy) · Berlin, Germany*

- Held the Secretary and Facilitator roles under Holacracy, and ran governance meetings.
- Holacracy is a matrix organization with the authority written down, and I had confidence operating in it because I had been trained to run it.
- Governance meetings are where roles get created, accountabilities move and circles are restructured — the structure editing itself, on the record.
- Qualified for both: Holacracy Taster, then the Intensive Training with the Facilitator and Secretary Qualification, 2021.
- Personnel authority and process authority sat with different roles by constitutional design — the same split Toll Collect runs between fachliche Leads and People Leads.
- Ran design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams, and partnered with the group executive team on turning services into a product catalog.
- Secretary and Facilitator. Both held, both qualified.

### Director of Design

2016 – 2021

*Datameer GmbH (data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC*

- Led the design team across Germany and New York for five years. Two time zones, and the development conversations happened over video long before that was normal.
- Five years of enterprise software under regulation, for banks and insurers in three countries.

## ALONGSIDE ALL OF IT

Two tracks have run in parallel for a decade. This one is the people work, and it is the track this role is about.

Senior Mentor, CareerFoundry · Mentor, Interaction Design Foundation

2016 – 2026

A decade developing people who had no obligation to listen to me. None of them reported to me and none of it ran on positional authority. Sustained one-to-one relationships over months — goals, feedback, and the honest conversation about what someone is not yet ready for. This is the part of leading people I have done longest.

Oratio&Co

Ongoing

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

## EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig · inside a product triad, 200+ people

Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA

## EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

Completed 2026

## LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

## SKILLS

### Developing people

A decade mentoring and coaching without line authority · a levelling framework across two disciplines · growth plans and level requirements · performance reviews · a lean 360 designed and run as a workshop · hiring, promoting and managing exits

### Shared leadership

Holacracy Secretary and Facilitator, held and served · governance meetings run · Holacracy Intensive Training qualification, 2021 · personnel and process authority held separately by design · senior leadership team member

### Leadership practice

M.A. Leadership, Kairos University · collaborative leadership coaching practice · design-thinking training for executive leadership · changing the conditions rather than managing the person · coaching through broken cross-functional relationships

### Context

Design leadership in B2B SaaS, enterprise analytics and broadcast · teams across Germany and New York · six countries under GDPR and church data-protection law · native German, C2 English